

Verification & Launch Readiness

Affiliate, Payments & Codebase Review

Prepared for Rapunzel Withtwins / Bethanie Ashton
July 2026

MATERIALIZED

Reviewed codebase: github.com/missbethanieashton/Video-Commerce-Engine-2

Production build: materialized-app.vercel.app (migrated)

Event target: first-brand launch — Sat ~25 July 2026

Summary

Ahead of the launch event, I audited the affiliate / UTM / payout chain end-to-end against your requirements, and compared the two live codebases. The attribution foundation is genuinely in place. The pieces that remain are the ones that move or verify real money — which is exactly where careful work matters most, and which we have time to get right before real payouts begin.

This report covers three things: **(1)** what is verified and working, **(2)** what I am building or hardening for the event and shortly after, and **(3)** a recommendation on which codebase to launch from.

Verified & working

- ✓ **Publisher portal** — the full /affiliate experience (dashboard, library, campaigns, analytics, settings, subscription) with its own navigation. "Publisher" is the user-facing label for this interface.
- ✓ **UTM generation & resolution** — unique codes per video and per repost, resolving back to the correct affiliate/publisher.
- ✓ **View & click tracking** — embed loads and product clicks are captured and attributed, with per-domain deployment tracking.
- ✓ **Commission ledger** — a per-affiliate commission record with an admin override (adjustable per user).
- ✓ **Stripe subscription billing** — checkout, billing portal, and subscription lifecycle handling.

To build or harden

None of these are surprises — they are the standard "make the money trustworthy" layer that comes after a prototype. Sequenced against the event:

Item	Status	Why it matters	When
Fee & split model (15% / 8% / 2% / 85%)	To build	The split logic isn't in the code yet — commissions currently default to a flat 10%. Needs the configurable, admin-adjustable model below.	Before event
Verified purchase tracking	To harden	Sale/commission events are currently client-reported and unauthenticated. Before real money is attributed, these must be verified server-side from the store.	Event: UTM tracking live + sales reconciled from your store export. Automated verification: fast-follow.
Automated payouts (Stripe Connect)	To build	The payout transfer is scaffolded but not yet executing. Needs the full flow: attributed → approved → paid, with duplicate-safety and a minimum threshold.	Fast-follow (aligns with the 30-day influencer payout norm)

Money precision (integer-cents math)	To harden	Amounts are computed as decimals; converting to integer-cents removes any rounding drift on payouts.	Fast-follow
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Confirmed commission model

Built as configurable defaults, admin-adjustable — and adjustable per individual user for creator/publisher commissions.

Party	Default share of a gross sale	Notes
Brand	85%	Adjustable by admin
Marketplace fee	15%	Adjustable by admin; covers the below
↳ Creator	8%	Adjustable per user
↳ Publisher	2%	Adjustable per user
↳ Platform + processing	~5%	Remainder of the fee

Codebase recommendation

There are currently two versions of Materialized: the **Replit** project, and the **migrated production build** already deployed to Vercel/Railway. For the fastest, safest launch, I recommend launching from the **migrated build**:

- It already has the pieces the event needs — **brand inventory sync (Shopify/WooCommerce)**, media hosting, transactional email, and live deployment.
- The Replit version predates the migration and is missing those, so launching from it would mean redoing work that's already done.
- Your recent design refresh (fonts, cursor, Campaign ROI view, publisher subscription page) is small and I'll fold it into the production build.

Going forward: to avoid maintaining two diverging copies, it's cleanest to keep one production home for the code and fold design ideas into it, rather than re-migrating from Replit each time. Happy to walk through this on a call.

Launch plan — target Sat ~25 July

Track	Scope
Live for event	

Production deploy of the current build · brand inventory sync verified · product discovery + carousel with UTM tracking · dashboard analytics (views, clicks, sales, commission totals) · the 15% / 85% fee split calculated correctly.

Fast-follow

Automated affiliate/publisher payouts · verified store-sale webhook + 60-day attribution window · integer-cents refactor.

Dependency to note: live card payments switch on only once Stripe finishes its account review (typically 2–3 days). This does not block the event itself — sales are tracked via UTM during the event and reconciled from your store export, and influencer payouts follow later.

Prepared by Mukela Katungu · Verification performed against the live repository and deployed build.